

Synonyms for "Good"

A Quick-Reference Guide

Universal Words	Preface Words	One-Context Words
- great - wonderful - super - fabulous - splendid - fantastic - excellent - exceptional - delightful - marvelous - impeccable - magnificent - super-fantastic - amazing - superb - sublime - swell (old) - grand - positive - extraordinary - fantabulous (fantastic + fabulous) - splendiferous (informal/slang) - spectacular (very informal) Phrases: - fine and dandy (informal/slang) - couldn't be better E.g. Greeting: Q: How are you today? A: _____.	<i>E.g. It's _____ amazing.</i> - quite + (universal word; nice, good); not: great, super, excellent, delightful, swell, positive - simply + (universal word; grand; fine; wonderful); not: good, nice, well, great phrases - positively + (universal word); not: good, nice, well, phrases - absolutely + (universal word); not: positive, super, great, swell, excellent, impeccable, superb, phrases - exceptionally + (only: fine, good, delicious, wonderful, grand) - just + (great, wonderful, fabulous, fantastic, delightful (not yourself); marvelous; amazing (not yourself); exquisite(not yourself); grand(not yourself); extraordinary(not yourself)); spectacular (not yourself); fine and dandy); not super, splendid, excellent, exceptional, delightful, super fan, superb, swell, sublime, positive - truly + (not yourself)(only: amazing, marvelous, magnificent, exceptional, delightful, wonderful, splendid) - really + (universal word); not good, well Note: Most or all of the universal words can become "ly" adverbs, but usually using these as prefaces for others is uncommon. Sometimes it sounds cute (amazingly super-fantastic), other times meaningless (marvelously impeccable), neither is formal or polite.	For compliments, opinions, or descriptions, these words can be used in one (or more) context but not others. Clothing: - breathtaking - dazzling (clothing) - smart (clothing) (not in the USA) - stylish (clothing) "looks good on you" (clothing, "That shirt looks good on you.") - stunning - marvelous [to women only] beautiful, cute [to men only] handsome Food: - delicious - exquisite - delectable - scrumptious (informal) - rare (old, British) - choice (more formal) [Avoid using nice or fine, for food, these are common "polite" terms for saying you don't like the food.] Visual item: (picture, movie, art) - breathtaking - beautiful - impressive - stunning - inspired - spectacular Contextual Preface Words: "most " - food or visual only "exceptionally" - clothing only "very" + (delicious, stylish, beautiful, cute, handsome, impressive)
Difficult-to-Use Words: Don't risk it - say "great."		
Good [& well]; nice; fine; fare: These words may be wise to avoid as they can have the opposite meaning, due to context, nuance, subtle pronunciation, etc. Rule of Thumb: "fine" alone = so-so, or worse. (difficult intonation can be an exception) "_____ + fine" = Good"simply fine, just fine, quite fine" can be used for any context <i>but</i> the wrong tone of voice, pronunciation, or intonation can reverse to meaning. Set phrases "fine weather" and "I'm fine, how are you?" are also exceptions.		

Good vs. Well : no consensus; rule of thumb: situation = well; salable product = good.